

(sometimes even twice or thrice that of conventional crops) but the health benefits seemed to counterbalance the cost. Every thought organic foods were pesticide free and were hence superior alternatives to regular, conventionally farmed produce.

The reality is quite different. Organic foods ARE subjected to pesticides while being produced, but what is different is the nature of these pesticides. Simply put, organic foods are farmed using organic pesticides. As reported by the Scientific American, “Organic pesticides are those that are derived from natural sources and processed lightly if at all before use. It has been assumed for years that pesticides that occur naturally (in certain plants, for example) are somehow better for us and the environment than those that have been created by man. As more research is done into their toxicity, however, this simply isn’t true, either. Many natural pesticides have been found to be potential – or serious – health risks.” (link - <http://goo.gl/xSWb9>) An example of this is Rotenone, a widely used pesticide and insecticide derived from the roots of some plants. Since the chemical can be naturally obtained, many would be led to believe that it is benign. However, Rotenone has been known to cause Parkinson’s Disease by attacking the mitochondrion of cells.



Organic Foods: There's a lot more to them than meets the eye